

March

21

1871

German chancellor

Otto von Bismarck was declared the first chancellor of the German Empire. He united the German states into a powerful nation. Under his rule, Germany retained its dominance in Europe until World War I.



Born this day

1685 Johann Sebastian Bach, German composer. A talented organist and violinist, he wrote music for choirs and orchestras, and is famous for the *Brandenburg Concertos*.

1806 Benito Pablo Juárez García, Mexican politician. He became the first Indigenous president of Mexico in 1858.

1846

All that jazz

Belgian musician and instrument maker Adolphe Sax filed a patent for eight different types of wind instrument, all variations of the saxophone. His invention later became popular with jazz musicians.



Also on this day

1916 US chess champion
Frank James Marshall played a record-breaking 105 games at the same time in a tournament in Washington, DC, USA.

1935 Shah of Iran Reza Shah Pahlavi requested that Persia be called Iran by other nations.

2006 The first message was sent using Twitter, when its US founder Jack Dorsey published the tweet, "Just setting up my twttr".

Ballooning record

1999

Swiss explorer Bertrand Piccard and British balloonist Brian Jones became the first people to travel around the world non-stop in a hot-air balloon. Their *Breitling Orbiter 3* landed near Cairo, Egypt, at the end of their 20-day journey.

